Strategic Pathways – Developer Overview Brief

1. What Strategic Pathways Is

Strategic Pathways is a Kenya-based digital platform designed to mobilise study-abroad returnees and diaspora professionals into locally impactful projects, ventures, and consultancy engagements.

The core idea is **"brain circulation"** ensuring that global skills gained abroad are deployed productively in local economies.

Strategic Pathways is not:

- A job board
- A social network
- A traditional NGO

It is a **talent execution and venture-building platform** that connects skilled professionals to structured opportunities.

2. The Core Problem

Many globally trained professionals returning to Kenya face:

- Fragmented networks
- Limited structured collaboration pathways
- Underemployment or skills underutilisation
- Difficulty accessing credible project opportunities

At the same time:

- Counties, NGOs, and SMEs struggle to find reliable execution teams
- Donors seek measurable local capacity building
- Diaspora professionals want structured ways to contribute

Strategic Pathways connects these supply and demand sides.

3. How the Platform Works (Business Model Logic)

The platform functions in 4 stages:

1. **User Onboarding**
    - Professionals create profiles
    - Capture skills, sector expertise, geography
2. **Opportunity Access**

    - Projects, consultancy calls, venture cohorts
    - Institutional partnerships
3. **Team Assembly**
    - Cross-functional team formation
    - Execution-based collaboration
4. **Revenue Generation**
    - Subscription fees (premium features)
    - Project management fees (B2B/B2G)
    - Institutional partnerships
    - Venture equity (future phase)

4. Target Users

Primary Users (B2C)

- Study-abroad returnees
- Diaspora professionals

Secondary Users (B2B/B2G)

- NGOs
- Donors
- County governments
- Universities
- SMEs

The website must serve both individual users and institutions clearly.

5. What the Website Must Enable (Phase 1 – MVP)

The website should:

- Clearly explain the value proposition
- Allow user registration (and profile creation with verification)
- Allow volunteer applications
- Allow institutional inquiry submissions
- Support payments for subscriptions
- Allow content updates without developer dependency
- Capture user data securely
- Track basic analytics

This is a **functional MVP**, not a complex AI matching platform.

6. Core Functional Priorities

Must Have (Phase 1)

- Mobile-responsive design

- User sign-up & login
- Admin dashboard
- Basic profile management
- Payment integration
- Contact forms
- Blog/insights section
- Volunteer application form

Should Be Scalable For:

- Team matching engine
- Venture incubation dashboard
- Project management modules
- Tiered membership permissions
- Institutional portals

Architecture must allow future expansion without rebuild.

7. Design Expectations

Tone:

- Professional
- Policy-credible
- Trustworthy
- Development-aligned
- Modern but not overly “startup flashy”

Visual identity should communicate:

- Trust
- Growth
- Global-local connection
- Structured collaboration

8. Data & Security Considerations

The platform will collect:

- Personal data
- Professional backgrounds
- Skills and location data

Must comply with:

- Kenya Data Protection Act
- Standard web security practices
- SSL encryption

User data integrity is critical.

9. Success Criteria for Developers

The platform is successful if:

- Users can register smoothly on mobile
- Admin can update content independently
- Payments work reliably
- Site loads quickly
- Architecture allows modular growth
- It supports credibility in donor and institutional contexts

10. Long-Term Vision (For Technical Foresight)

Strategic Pathways aims to evolve into:

- A national talent infrastructure platform
- A structured team-assembly engine
- A venture-building ecosystem
- A cross-county execution network

Developers should think in terms of:

- Scalable database structure
- Modular features
- Role-based permissions
- Future API integrations

Summary for Developers

Strategic Pathways is building a structured collaboration and execution platform that connects globally trained talent with locally grounded economic opportunities.

The website is not just informational, it is the foundation of a scalable digital ecosystem.

The immediate goal is a lean, credible MVP that:

- Attracts early users
- Supports partnerships
- Enables monetisation
- Builds institutional trust